

You will currently need to use the BlackBerry Tablet OS SDK and simulator to make these apps. After you've downloaded and installed them, you're ready to start developing apps with Flash Builder 4.5. The latest SDK has a BlackBerry Torch browser in it, so that the developers can not only test their AIR apps but also test their Flash web sites to see how it would look on the tablet browser. In case you choose to make your application look like the native BlackBerry PlayBook apps, a few of which have actually been created using AIR you can use the BlackBerry Tablet OS SDK for Adobe AIR. This SDK not only provides a library of UI classes that are same as the classes used for the PlayBook UI itself.

The SDK also lets you package and deploy PlayBook applications .bar files to the PlayBook simulator that can be run on your desktop. So basically making use of the SDK you can access the battery level or get a notification directly when a low memory event occurs. You can get more details on these APIs, from the 'BlackBerry Tablet OS SDK for Adobe AIR API Reference' available online. So to put it simply, you can develop applications using Flex 4.5 or just ActionScript for Blackberry devices as well. Just as in the case of Android app development, you can develop apps for Blackberry by using Flash Professional CS5 also. Adobe has been constantly working with RIM to make it easier and easier to build apps for the BlackBerry PlayBook using Flex.

iOS devices

If you look back at the history of what we call 'smartphones' in modern days and their application development with Adobe products, iOS was the first mobile platform that Adobe supported. Adobe had announced it in 2009 at Adobe MAX and subsequently released the Packager for iPhone in 2010 as part of the Adobe CS5 launch. If you want to develop applications for iPhone, iPod touch, and iPad, you can now use Adobe Flash Builder 4.5, and Flex 4.5, which, with their rich feature set let you deploy apps across the iPhone and iPad, without you having to bother about form factor or screen resolutions.

You can debug the application within Flash Builder, rather than the usual misery of installation and reinstallation of the app on the device. You can also debug directly on the device; however, the iPhone, iPod or iPad must be connected on the same Wi-Fi network as the computer on which the debugger is running. Similar to the Blackberry Tablet OS, with the June update of Flash Builder 4.5.1, you can also package applications built with Flex 4.5 and AIR code base.